

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Before the Storm

*A PMDD Journal for the Week That Turns on
You*



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for cycle warriors

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Every month, like weather, it rolls in: the rage, the despair, the version of you that doesn't feel like you. And every month it lifts — leaving you to clean up and brace again.

This journal takes your storms seriously. Not 'just PMS,' not dramatic — a real pattern that deserves real strategy.

These pages help you learn your storm: when it comes, what it says, what helps, and how to protect yourself and your relationships while it passes.

One important note: PMDD is worth telling a doctor about.

Real treatments exist, and you deserve every tool — this journal works best alongside them, not instead of them.

STARTING POINT

My Storm, In My Words



Describe your hardest days each cycle — what changes in your mood, your thoughts, your body, your relationships. Get the whole storm on paper.

PART ONE

Knowing the Storm



*Storms are survivable when you can see them
coming.*

When in your cycle does it usually start, and what are your first warning signs — the earliest whispers?



What thoughts show up during the storm that vanish when it passes? Write the greatest hits.



What does the storm say about you, your relationships, your life — and how much of it holds up on your clear days?



What tends to make your storm worse — poor sleep, conflict, alcohol, overscheduling? Name your amplifiers.



How long does your storm typically last, and how do you know when it's lifting?



What has the storm cost you so far — words said, plans dropped, days lost? Grieve it honestly here.



PART TWO

Weathering It



*You can't cancel the storm. You CAN
storm-proof the house.*

What actually helps even a little during the storm — rest, movement, quiet, crying it out? Build your evidence list.



What needs to come OFF your calendar during storm week? Give yourself permission to schedule around it.



What do you need from the people close to you during the storm — space, softness, patience, no big talks?



How could you tell them BEFORE the storm? Draft the words here: 'Next week I might be...'



What rules serve you during the storm — no big decisions, no important conversations, no believing every thought?



*Write a note from clear-day you to storm-day you.
What does she need to hear when everything feels
true and terrible?*



PART THREE

After the Storm



*The storm isn't your character. The repair and
the prep — that's your character.*

When it lifts, what do you usually feel — relief, guilt, embarrassment? Meet those feelings with some mercy here.



Is there any repair to do this cycle — a snap, a cancellation, a hard word? Plan the honest, simple repair.



What did this last storm teach you that you can use next cycle?



How can you forgive yourself for who you are during the storm while still taking care of what happens in it?



What would tracking look like for you — this journal, an app, a calendar — so the storm stops surprising you?



What's your full storm plan now? Warning signs, calendar moves, people told, comforts ready. Write the whole playbook.



The Storm-Week Survival Kit



Prep these BEFORE it rolls in. Check what goes in your kit.

- ☐ Tell my people the forecast: 'rough week coming, nothing personal'
- ☐ Clear what can be cleared from the calendar
- ☐ No major decisions or big conversations until it lifts
- ☐ Comforts stocked: the foods, the shows, the soft clothes
- ☐ Sleep protected like it's my job
- ☐ Move gently — walks count double this week
- ☐ Write in this journal instead of texting the storm's opinions
- ☐ Repeat: 'this is the storm talking, and it passes'
- ☐ Ask for help with one thing instead of white-knuckling all of it
- ☐ Mark the calendar so next month I see it coming

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

What Actually Helps



Every cycle teaches you something. Log what helped here — your personal storm manual, written by the only expert on you.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



You live with weather most people can't see —
and you keep showing up for your life anyway.
That's not weakness. That's a monthly act of courage.

Learn your storm. Prep for your storm. Forgive
yourself for your storm. And please — bring a doctor
onto your team if you haven't. PMDD is real,
it's treatable, and you were never 'too much.'
You were carrying too much, alone. Not anymore.



*You are not the storm. You're the one
who survives it monthly.*



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